Claims and Reimbursement Guide

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1. Who Files the Claim

In-network providers file claims with Northwind directly, and the member does not need to submit anything. Members only file a claim when they paid out of pocket for a covered service, or when they received care from an out-of-network provider.

2. Filing Deadline and Required Documents

A member must file a claim within 180 days of the date of service. Claims filed after that date may be denied. Each claim must include:

- A completed claim form (Form NHP-C1).
- An itemized bill from the provider.
- Proof of payment, if the member paid the provider.

Claims can be mailed to Northwind Claims, PO Box 5400, Springfield, or uploaded through the Member Portal.

3. Processing and Payment

Northwind processes a clean claim within 30 calendar days of receipt. If a claim is incomplete, Northwind returns it within 10 business days and explains what is missing. For approved out-of-network claims, reimbursement is sent to the member by check or direct deposit within 14 days of approval. For in-network claims, payment is sent to the provider.

4. Balance Billing

In-network providers may not bill a member for any amount above the Northwind allowed amount, other than the member's deductible, copay, or coinsurance. Out-of-network providers may bill the member for the difference between their charge and the allowed amount.

5. Coordination of Benefits

When a member is covered by more than one health plan, the primary plan pays first and Northwind, as the secondary plan, may pay part of the remaining balance. For a child covered under both parents' plans, the birthday rule applies: the plan of the parent whose birthday falls earlier in the calendar year is the primary plan.

6. Appealing a Denied Claim

A member may appeal a denied claim within 180 calendar days of the date on the denial notice. Northwind decides claim appeals within 45 calendar days. Appeals about denied prior authorization requests follow a separate process and deadlines, described in the Prior Authorization Policy (NHP-PA-2026).